

ResearchAbstract

InSight:

Microsoft Corporation

**Upgrading to Windows XP: A
Long and Winding Road**

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With the long-anticipated launch of Microsoft's Windows XP operating system - backed by a \$200 million marketing program - technologists may be tempted to upgrade their existing machines. With an XP upgrade, users will get the enterprise stability and speed of Windows 2000 while enjoying a raft of new features supporting audio and visual digital media and networking.

However, our experiences with upgrading PCs to Windows XP - documented in this *InSight* - make us recommend such an upgrade only if it is performed by a good technician. Most consumers and small businesses that want or need the excellent capabilities of Windows XP should opt for a factory-installed version on a new PC - which, costing around \$1,000, should be a bargain.

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Microsoft, Windows, operating systems, wireless, LAN, small office, home office, SOHO, media player, user experience, Windows XP, Agere, Orinoco, WEP, Intel, Compaq, Dell, Hewlett-Packard, IBM